

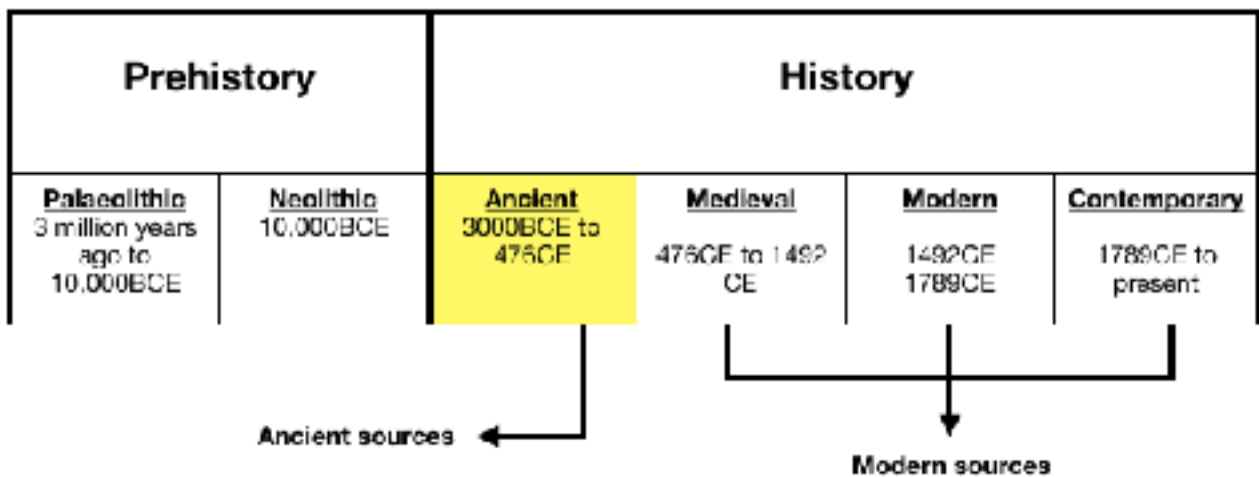
Year 11 General Ancient History **Assessment Guide**

Teacher: Ms Barrie

SOURCE ANALYSIS

Ancient vs. Modern Sources

Ancient history as a term refers to the aggregate of past events from the beginning of writing and recorded human history and extending as far as the end of the Western Roman Empire c. 476CE

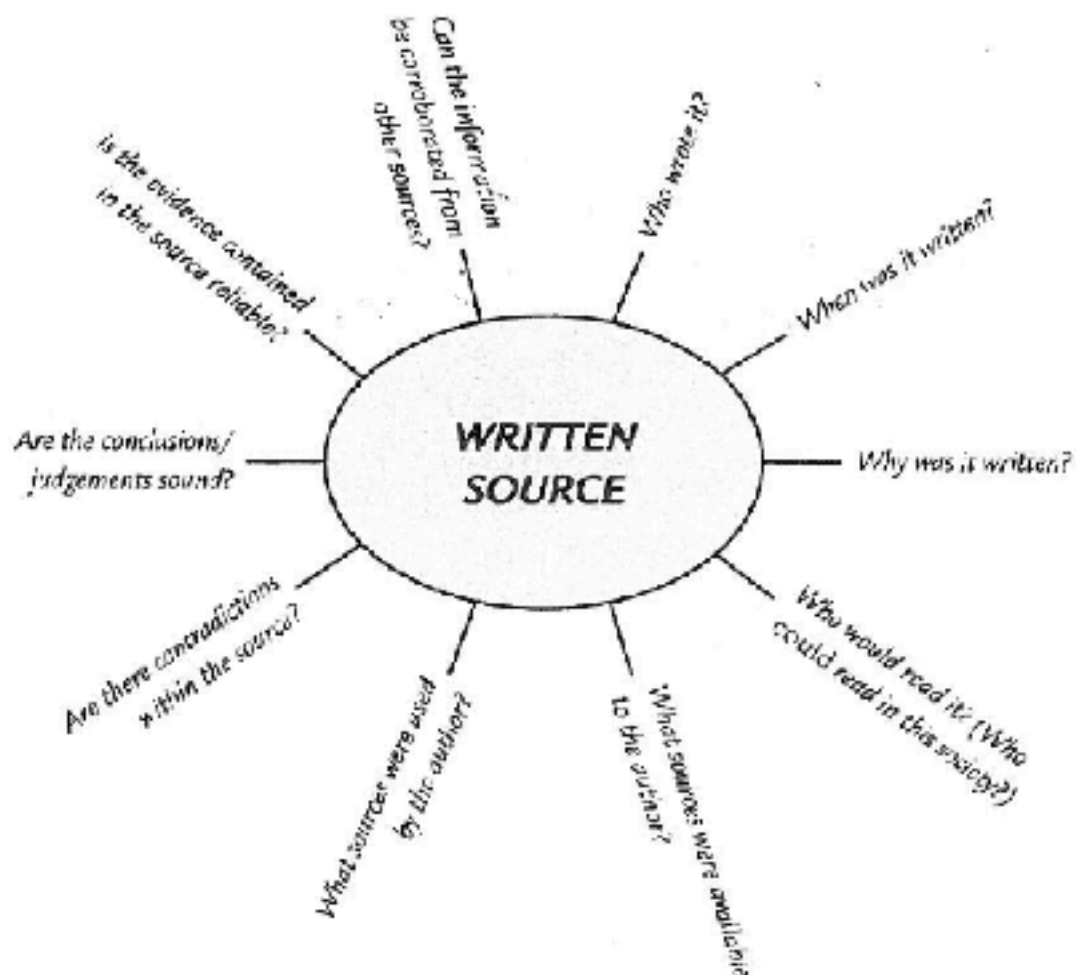


Types of sources: Archaeological vs. Written

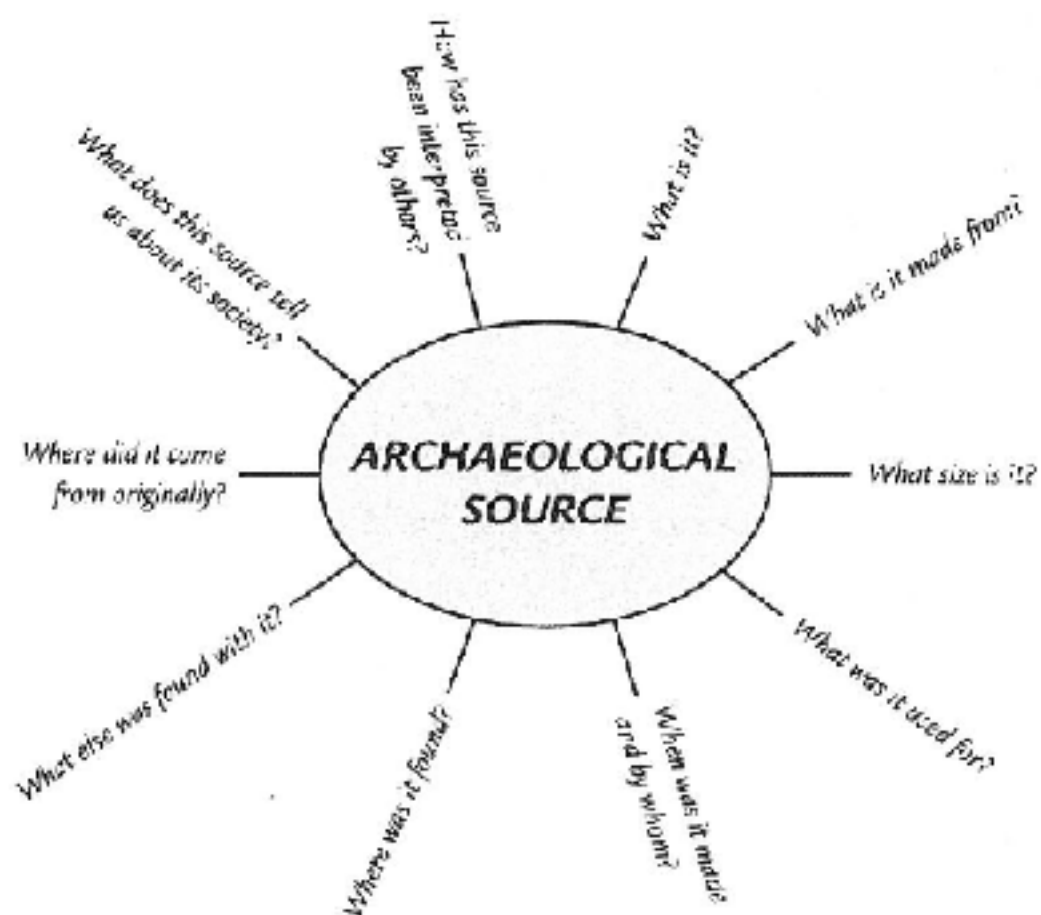
Archaeological and written sources are the two important and main sources of history. The differences between the two are as:

- The archaeological sources include material things like artefacts, buildings, inscriptions, coins etc while as literary sources include written literature in the form of books, biographies etc.
- Archaeological sources are primary sources (first hand evidence) while as written sources are both primary and secondary.
- Archaeological sources cover more than 99% of history of mankind while as literary sources less than 1%. Archaeological sources are only source of our pre-history.
- Archaeological sources present true picture of the time as they are without any bias. While as written sources are mostly biased and exaggerated.

Questions to ask of written sources



Questions to ask of archaeological sources



NOTE: These questions are different between Unit 1 and Unit 2

QUESTIONS - Unit 1

For Ancient History Unit 1, there are five (5) questions you will need to respond to, and two (2) sources.

1. Tick one of the following in (a) and (b) to best describe the source (2 marks)

- A) ancient source OR modern source
B) written source OR archaeological source OR map/diagram OR reconstruction

2. Identify and discuss the historical context of the source (4 marks)

KEY WORDS:

Identify: Recognise and name

Discuss: Identify issues and provide points for and/or against

Historical Context

Significant people, events, and ideas.

3. Identify and explain message/s of the source. Provide evidence in your response (4 marks)

KEY WORDS:

Identify: Recognise and name

Explain: Relate cause and effect; make the relationships between things evident; provide why and/or how

Message/s

What is the creator/author trying to say about the sources purpose?

Are there any inferences the creator/author expects you to make?

How can you tell what the message is?

4. Using your own knowledge of your period of study, discuss the contribution of Source 1 AND Source 2 to our understanding of Minoan Civilisation (6 marks)

KEY WORDS:

Discuss: Identify issues and provide points for and/or against

Contribution to understanding

Location of civilisation and nature of source

Evaluate the extent to which the source had relevance to, or affected our modern understanding of a civilisation

Importance of source to civilisation - use, purpose, effect

To what extent does the source contribute to understanding?

5. Discuss the usefulness of Source 1 and Source 2 in relation to how important the Minoans were in the Mediterranean region, during the time period of study (9 marks)

KEY WORDS:

Discuss: Identify issues and provide points for and/or against

Consider: Reflect on and make a judgement/evaluation

You need to ensure you use EXAMPLES from your own knowledge and the source.

Q: Which aspects of S.P.E.R.M does the source show? How does this link to Minoan society?

Strengths

What features are there that make the source useful? e.g. clear purpose, indicate context accurately, provide insight, clear communication

Weaknesses

Are there any omissions/limitations of the source? e.g. unclear, may not be objective or provide accurate insight into context

Historical context - People/Events/Ideas

Historical context requires you to describe/discuss the background of the source. When examining the historical context of a source, you must examine the...

- PEOPLE (who/what groups were shown or involved?)
- EVENTS (what occurred and when?)
- IDEAS (what ideas permeated the events/were shared by people?)

..of each source.

For example:

PEOPLE, EVENTS, IDEAS

For example:

Weni's tomb was found with a false door. This is not surprising because false doors were used in Mastabas from the early dynastic period right through to the end of the Old Kingdom. This is due to the belief that... etc. What was surprising was that Weni was not buried next to a Pharaoh. As vizier Weni himself was an important person. During the later stages of the Old Kingdom Viziers & royal officials rose in importance.

S.P.E.R.M

S.P.E.R.M - A model for classifying historical events and ideas		
S	Social	Behaviour patterns and cultural values and norms
P	Political	Function of internal and external politics, or political relations
E	Economic	Structure or functioning of an economic system
R	Religious	Adoption of a set of beliefs identified with one particular religious denomination (often to the exclusion of others)
M	Military	Structure or functioning of a nation's military/army/warfare

Questions to consider:

- Which of the above does this source MOST refer to (one or more), and why?
- What are the effects of this change and/or continuity on society?